

LRI Emergency Department Decision aid for major trauma or critical illness in the pregnant patient

Use for all pregnant patients
>16+0 wks to 42 days postpartum
presenting with medical / surgical
problem or trauma

Approved UHL
PGC,
ED,
MAT
GOV
On
August
2021
Review
due
August
2024

Seen by:

Grade:

Date:

Time:

Patient Details

Full Name:
DoB:
Unit number:

(Use sticker if available)



Brief assessment including
MEOWS score

Any life-threatening
feature (box 1)?

Y

N

Call the Obstetric
Emergency Team
NOW
For expected members see
box 3

Time call made:

Any severe
features (box 2)?

Y

N

Request **IMMEDIATE
ATTENDANCE** of the
most senior resident
obstetrician AND
obstetric anaesthetist
(box 4)

Time call made:

Is the problem
purely pregnancy
related?

Y

N

Referral to be
completed through
nervecentre e-
referrals, follow up
with phone call to
MAU if $\geq 16/40$ or
P/N GAU if $\leq 15+6$
if urgent

Obtain specialty
review as
appropriate and
then notify
maternity bleep
holder (bleep
4001)

Whilst awaiting obstetric team

- Site two large bore cannulae
- Obtain bloods including G&S
- Insert urinary catheter with hourly bag
- If >20 weeks gestation, use left lateral tilt or manual uterine displacement
- Continue management as per non-pregnant patient

**DO NOT DELAY ANY EMERGENCY
INVESTIGATIONS OR LIFESAVING
TREATMENTS DUE TO PREGNANCY**

BOX 1: Life threatening features

- ☐ Periarrest/Arrest
- ☐ Vaginal bleeding
>1000ml antenatal
>1500ml postnatal (see appendix 2)
- ☐ Eclampsia
- ☐ Any trauma requiring ER
- ☐ Significant trauma to the abdomen
- ☐ Any medical condition requiring critical care transfer
- ☐ Surgical condition requiring immediate operation
- ☐ GCS <8
- ☐ Any severe feature where intrauterine death is suspected or confirmed

BOX 2: Severe features

- ☐ Confusion or reduced conscious level (GCS <12)
- ☐ Vaginal bleeding
 - ☐ 50-1000ml antenatal
 - ☐ 500ml postnatal (appendix 2)
- ☐ Systolic Hypertension >160 mmhg
- ☐ MEOWS >6

Box 3: Obstetric Emergency Team

- Obstetric SR, Registrar & Junior
- Obstetric Anaesthetist
- Obstetric Theatre Team
- Neonatologist
- NB Consultant Obstetrician does NOT carry crash bleep, can be contacted on mobile via switch

Box 4: Obstetric team contact:

- 8am-10pm Obstetric consultant via switchboard
- 22:00-08:00 SR bleep 4294
- Labour ward red phone 17765
- Obs Anaesthesia contact
- 08:00-22:00 Consultant obstetric anaesthetist via switchboard
- 22:00-08:00 SR bleep 4127
- Escalate to on-call consultant via switchboard if no timely response from either team

Modified Obstetric Early Warning Score (MEOWS):

[illegible]